DEFINITION Segments that use a character other than `/` are called *complex segments*. I generally recommend that you avoid them and stick to using `/` as a separator. Complex segments have some peculiarities that make them hard to use, so be sure to check the documentation at http://mng.bz/D4RE before you use them.

Each segment is either

- *A literal value* such as `product` in figure 6.5
- *A route parameter* such as `{category}` and `{name}` in figure 6.5

The request URL must match literal values exactly (ignoring case). If you need to match a particular URL exactly, you can use a template consisting only of literals.

TIP Literal segments in ASP.NET Core aren't case-sensitive.

Imagine that you have a minimal API in your application defined using

```
app.MapGet("/About/Contact", () => {/* */})
```

This route template, "`/About/Contact`", consists only of literal values, so it matches only the exact URL (ignoring case). None of the following URLs would match this route template:

- `/about`
- `/about-us/contact`
- `/about/contact/email`
- `/about/contact-us`